Jiakai Chen, Ph.D., CFA

Shidler College of Business, University of Hawaii at Manoa
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RESEARCH INTERESTS Financial Intermediaries, Real Estate Finance, Capital Markets

EMPLOYMENT

University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI
Department of Finance, Shidler College of Business
First Hawaiian Bank Distinguished Professor, 2023 - present
Associate Professor of Finance, 2023 - present
Assistant Professor of Finance, 2015 - 2023

VISITING

Federal Reserve Bank of New York, New York, NY
Research and Statistics Group
Visiting Economist, February - March, 2024
Visiting Economist, August - December, 2019

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, Berkeley, CA, USA
Haas School of Business
Ph.D. in Finance and Real Estate, 2015

PUBLICATIONS

Academic Research

Peer-to-Peer Lending: Shift of Pricing Regime and Changes in Risk Sensitivity, *with Wei Huang and Xinruo Emma Wang*
Journal of Banking and Finance, Volume 176, July 2025, 107459

Market Discipline and Regulatory Arbitrage: Evidence from ABCP Liquidity Guarantors
Journal of Banking and Finance, Volume 145, December 2022, 106656.

Do Low Search Costs Facilitate Like-buys-like Mergers? Evidence from Common Bank Networks, *with Joonho Kim and S. Ghon Rhee*
Journal of Financial Economics, Volume 140, Issue 2, May 2021, Pages 484-513.

LIBOR's Poker
Journal of Financial Markets, Volume 55, September 2021, 100586.

Modeling of Mortgage Defaults, *with L. S. Hayre, M. Saraf, and R. A. Young*
Journal of Fixed Income, Spring 2008, Vol. 17, No. 4: pp. 6-30.

Government Policy Analysis

Did Dealers Fail to Make Markets during the Pandemic? *with Haoyang Liu, David Rubio, Asani Sarkar, and Zhaogang Song*
Liberty Street Economics, March 2021.

MBS Market Dysfunctions in the Time of COVID-19, *with Haoyang Liu, David Rubio, Asani Sarkar, and Zhaogang Song*
Liberty Street Economics, July 2020.
Highlighted in the speech at Bank of International Settlement by John C. Williams, the president of the Federal Reserve Bank of New York, in September 2020.

WORKING PAPERS

Dealers and the Dealer of Last Resort: Evidence from MBS Markets in the COVID-19 Crisis, *with Haoyang Liu, Asani Sarkar, and Zhaogang Song*
Federal Reserve Bank of New York Staff Report No. 933.
Revision requested at Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis
Cited by the Congressional Research Service Report #R46746 of the U.S. Congress on April 29, 2021.
Highlighted in the speech at Bank of International Settlement by John C. Williams, the president of the Federal Reserve Bank of New York, in September 2020.

The Writing on the Maturity Wall: Commercial Real Estate Performance and Rollover Risk, *with Yifan Chen*
Revision requested at Real Estate Economics

Credit Union Expansions: A Fork in the Road for Local Banks? *with Rodney Ramcharan, Teng Wang and Tim Zhang*
Semi-finalist of the Best Paper Award, FMA 2024

Artificial Intelligence and the Cost of Debt *with Talal Khan*

Ambiguity, Market Underreaction, and Post-Earnings Announcement Drifts, *with Qianqiu Liu, Xiaobo Liang, and S. Ghon Rhee*
Best Paper Award, China International Risk Forum 2022

Slowed-Down Capital: Using Bitcoin to Avoid Capital Controls, *With Asani Sarkar*
Highlighted in the speech of Jerome Powell, the chairman of the Federal Reserve System, in June 2022.

Does Analyst Reputation Matter for Firm Value? Evidence from Corporate Restatement, *with Boo Chun Jung and Joonho Kim*

PRESENTATIONS

2026: (including scheduled): AFA, ASSA-AREUEA (discussion), AREUEA National Conference, University of Georgia, Federal Reserve Board (x2). Florida International University, MRS
2025: University of Wisconsin at Madison (Dept. of Agricultural & Applied Economics), University of Wisconsin at Madison (Dept. of Real Estate and Urban Land Economics), AREUEA National Conference, AREUEA International Conference, Hospitality Finance Economics Conference, University of Hawaii at Manoa.
2024: ASSA-AREUEA (discussion), AREUEA National Conference, University of Texas at San Antonio, Community Banking Research Conference at the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, FMA.
2023: University of Wyoming, Federal Reserve Broad, Bank of England, Fudan University.
2022: Fordham University, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Inaugural conference on the International Roles of the U.S. Dollar by Federal Reserve, Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology,

FMA.
2021: FIRS, WFA, Yale Junior Finance Conference
2020: FMA, SFM, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, University of Massachusetts-Amherst, City College of New York, NYU Shanghai
2019: Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology, Nanyang Technological University
2018: Colorado University, National Central University
2017: AFA (discussion), NFA, Rice University, FMA Annual Meeting, Econometric Society Asia Meeting (2 papers)
2016: FMA, George Mason University, University of Wisconsin at Madison, Gerzensee Corporate Finance Week, Econometric Society Asia Meeting, Asian Finance Association (AsFA), FMA European, FIRS (discussion), EFA (2 papers), MFA
2015: EFA (discussion), Syracuse University
2014: Econometric Society European Meeting, EFA, Joint Berkeley - Stanford Finance Student Seminar
2013: London Business School - Transatlantic Doctoral Conference
2012: Oxford Financial Intermediation Theory Conference (OxFIT), Joint Berkeley - Stanford Finance Student Seminar, Australasian Finance and Banking Conference (AFBC), AFBC PhD Forum

GRANTS AND AWARDS

First Hawaiian Bank Distinguished Professorship in Banking, 2023 - present
Summer Research Grant, University of Hawaii at Manoa, 2016 - 2018, 2020 - present
SURE Research Grant, University of Hawaii at Manoa, 2026 ($5,000)
OVPRS Faculty Travel Awards, University of Hawaii at Manoa, 2016
Dissertation Research Award, Institute of Business and Economic Research, 2014
Fisher Center of Real Estate and Urban Economics Research Grant, UC Berkeley, 2014
Australasian Finance & Banking Conference Best Student Paper Award, 2013
Australasian Finance & Banking Conference Travel Grant, 2013
Claudius N. and James N. White Fellowship, UC Berkeley, 2011-2012
Gifford Fong Best Graduation Paper Award, UC Berkeley, 2006
Championship, Lehman Brother Financial Engineering Competition, 2006

TEACHING

Courses

University of Hawaii at Maona, Honolulu, HI, USA
Shidler College of Business
- BUS313 International Economics (Undergrad), Evaluation 4.6/5.0
- FIN435 Banking and Capital Markets (Undergrad), Evaluation: 5.0/5.0
- FIN460 Special Topics in Banking and Finance (Undergrad & Grad), Evaluation: 4.9/5.0
- FIN490D Financial Analysis (Undergrad), Evaluation: 5.0/5.0
- FIN703 Corporate Finance and Financial Intermediation (Ph.D.), Evaluation: 5.0/5.0

Ph.D. Advising and Placement

Finance

Scott Li ('17)	TTAP, California State Univ., Los Angeles
Tram Nguyen ('19)	TTAP, Univ. of Wisconsin-Whitewater
Xinruo Wang ('20)	TTAP, Univ. of Wisconsin-Eau Claire
Ming Shou ('22)	AP-in-Residence, Univ. of Nevada, Las Vegas
Hyeonjo Kim ('24)	TTAP, Augsburg Univ.
Xiaobo Liang ('24)	AP-in-Residence, Univ. of Nevada, Las Vegas
Gregory Gillis ('26)	TTAP, Western Kentucky Univ.
Zibo Wang (Ongoing)	
Fangdi Zhou (Ongoing)	
Haichen Yang (Ongoing, Co-chair)	
Talal Khan (Ongoing, Chair)	

Economics

Hamid Bouaicha (Ongoing)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Citigroup Investment Banking, New York, NY
Fixed Income Research & Quantitative Strategy
Mortgage Backed Securities Research Quant, 2006 - 2009

LANGUAGES English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

QUALIFICATIONS

Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA), Series 7, Oracle Certified Java Programmer (OCJP), Microsoft Certified System Engineer (MCSE).

WORK PERMIT

U.S. Permanent Residency (Green Card)

Updated August 2026